

General Examiner Rubric — Uganda New Curriculum

(Marking Criteria and Procedures)

This rubric guides examiners in awarding marks based on:

- Evidence of understanding
- Ability to apply knowledge
- Practical competence
- Communication
- Reasoning
- Authentic work produced during continuous assessment

Marks must be awarded only for **what is demonstrated on the script or in the assessed task**.

1. Knowledge and Conceptual Accuracy

Mark for:

- Correct facts, definitions, formulas, principles
- Accurate explanations of ideas
- Use of correct subject vocabulary
- Logical sequence of ideas
- Recognition of key terms in questions

How to award marks:

- Give full marks where explanations are complete and scientifically / academically correct.
- Give partial marks where the idea is present but incomplete, vague, or slightly inaccurate.
- Do not award marks for irrelevant statements.
- Credit alternative correct wording or methods.
- Ignore minor spelling errors unless they change meaning.

2. Application and Problem-Solving

Mark for:

- Correct use of methods or procedures
- Logical steps in working
- Interpretation of data, graphs, texts, or scenarios
- Transfer of knowledge to new contexts
- Practical decision-making

How to award marks:

- Allocate method marks even where the final answer is wrong, provided the reasoning is sound.
- Follow through correctly from a wrong earlier value if the method thereafter is correct.
- Do not penalise twice for the same mistake.
- Reward clear reasoning, even when the numerical answer is slightly off.
- Accept any valid approach that leads logically to a solution.

3. Practical Work and Projects

Mark for:

- Planning and organisation of tasks
- Safe and correct procedures
- Data collection or observations
- Construction or product quality
- Testing, modification, and reflection
- Conclusions linked to evidence

How to award marks:

- Credit genuine effort and process, not only the final product.
- Award marks for correct setup even if results are imperfect.
- Require evidence: logs, photographs, teacher records, reports, or artefacts.
- Penalise copying or fabricated work.
- Check that school-based marks are supported by records.

4. Communication and Presentation

Mark for:

- Clear structure of answers
- Logical flow
- Diagrams, tables, graphs where required
- Labelling
- Correct symbols and units
- Appropriate language for the subject

How to award marks:

- Award marks for clarity of explanation.
- Accept diagrams instead of words where appropriate.
- Penalise only errors that hinder understanding.
- Do not over-penalise handwriting unless unreadable.
- Ignore grammatical slips unless communication breaks down.

5. Reasoning, Evaluation, and Creativity

Mark for:

- Justification of answers
- Comparison of alternatives
- Drawing conclusions
- Explaining cause and effect
- Original or insightful approaches
- Awareness of limitations or assumptions

How to award marks:

- Credit any valid reasoning supported by evidence.
- Award marks for explaining *why*, not just stating *what*.
- Reward independent thought when consistent with subject knowledge.
- Do not reward unsupported opinions.

6. Use of Command Words

Examiners must interpret answers according to the task instruction:

- **Define** → precise meaning required
- **Describe** → characteristics or features
- **Explain** → give reasons or mechanisms
- **Calculate** → show working
- **Compare** → similarities and differences
- **Evaluate** → strengths and weaknesses with conclusion
- **Suggest** → plausible idea based on knowledge
- **Outline** → brief main points

Marks must match the depth demanded by the command word.

7. Allocation of Partial Credit

Principles:

- Break questions into identifiable marking points.
- Award marks for each valid step.
- Allow different correct methods.
- Apply “error-carried-forward” where appropriate.
- Avoid double penalties.
- Mark positively—look for what is correct.

8. Fairness and Standardisation

Examiners must:

- Use the same criteria for all candidates.
- Apply the marking scheme consistently across scripts.
- Adjust marking only after team standardisation.
- Record unusual but correct responses for moderation.
- Flag ambiguous items for review.

9. Handling Ambiguous or Unexpected Answers

- Accept any scientifically or logically valid response even if not anticipated.
- Consult senior examiners before penalising unusual answers.
- Document decisions for consistency.

10. Integrity and Authenticity

- Watch for identical scripts or improbable similarity in projects.
- Verify continuous assessment records.
- Report suspected malpractice through official channels.
- Do not guess marks where evidence is missing.

11. Examiner Conduct

Examiners should:

- Mark anonymously.
- Ignore personal opinions about schools or candidates.
- Base marks only on evidence.
- Keep scripts secure.
- Avoid fatigue errors—take breaks.